Advanced Punctuation (Set B)

Year 4 Pt 2 · **Mark Scheme**

Lesson Worksheet — Answers

Purple — Getting Started

1. The rain stopped; the sun came out.
2. We need these items: a pencil, a rubber and a ruler.
3. B) Tom said, "I am ready."
4. (My cousin (born in 2014) loves football.)
5. The dash pair correctly marks off the extra comment "though tiring".
6. "Can we go now?" asked Ben.
7. A) She packed: a hat, gloves and a scarf.; C) She needed three things: time, money and patience.; E) The winners were: Alex, Sam and Mo.
8. C) semicolon
9. "Stop right there!" yelled the guard.
10. A colon introduces the list that follows it, telling the reader 'here come the details'.
11. C) The lights went out; the storm was fierce.
12. The museum (which opens at nine) is free today.
13. Any correct example, e.g. Mum said, "Dinner is ready."
14. A) The match was close — until the final minute.; E) The game ended in a draw — a fair result.
15. It needs a capital letter at the start of the speech and punctuation inside the speech marks: He said, "Hello."

Green — Building Fluency

16. The exam was difficult; most pupils still passed.
17. There was only one explanation: he had forgotten his key.
18. A) "I think," said Mia, "we should leave now."
19. The weather forecast — and it is rarely wrong — predicted snow.
20. A comma can join a main clause to a less formal addition, but a semicolon joins two complete, closely related main clauses, e.g. 'It was raining; we stayed indoors' vs 'It was raining, so we stayed indoors.'
21. A) The bridge (built in 1920) is still standing.; C) The recipe (serves four) takes an hour.; E) Our teacher (Mr Hughes) is very strict.
22. "I cannot believe it," she whispered. "We actually won!"
23. B) colon
24. A dash feels more informal/dramatic and can appear mid-sentence easily, e.g. 'The cake — a chocolate one — was huge.' A colon is more formal and often introduces a list or explanation, e.g. 'He brought one thing: dessert.'
25. The team trained hard; they deserved to win.
26. A) She asked, "Are we late?"
27. There was a simple reason for his lateness: the bus never arrived.
28. A) She loves reading; he prefers films.; C) It was cold; we still went outside.; E) The shop closed early; customers were disappointed.
29. Any correct sentence using a colon before a dramatic statement, e.g. "Then she saw it: a dragon."
30. Any correct sentence punctuated three ways with a dash, brackets and commas, e.g. "My dog — a scruffy terrier — barked." / "My dog (a scruffy terrier) barked." / "My dog, a scruffy terrier, barked."

Red — Challenge

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31. "Are you coming?" asked Zara. "I will be there in a minute," replied Josh.
32. A semicolon joins two complete, equally weighted main clauses (e.g. 'She ran; he walked'); a colon introduces something that explains or lists what came before (e.g. 'She had one aim: to win'). Accept any correct original examples.
33. C) My favourite sports are these: football, tennis and swimming.
34. The recipe needs just one thing: patience, and plenty of it.
35. A) The bridge was closed; traffic was diverted.; C) Some pupils chose art; others chose drama.; E) It rained all day; the match still went ahead.
36. Any correct example, e.g. "Wait," she said. "I forgot my bag."
37. C) The result — incredibly — was a tie.
38. A colon introduces an explanation or example of what was just said ('something incredible' is then named as 'gold coins'); a semicolon only joins two equally weighted clauses, which this is not.
39. "I have found the answer," she exclaimed. "It was hidden in the attic the whole time."
40. A) He had one goal: to win; nothing else mattered.
41. A dash feels more dramatic/informal, e.g. 'The answer — surprisingly — was simple.' Brackets feel more formal/neutral for the same idea, e.g. 'The answer (surprisingly) was simple.'
42. The fire alarm rang; everyone evacuated calmly. (or: The fire alarm rang. Everyone evacuated calmly.)
43. A) "Why are we stopping?" asked Dev.; E) "Why are we stopping?" Dev asked.
44. Any correct sentence combining brackets and a colon, e.g. "My bag (a birthday gift) held three things: a book, a torch and a map."
45. It needs an exclamation mark (or full stop) and a closing speech mark before the reporting clause: He shouted, "Run!" and then disappeared.

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Homework Worksheet — Answers

Purple — Getting Started

1. The wind dropped; the sea grew calm.
2. Pack these items: a jumper, a hat and gloves.
3. B) Sam said, "I am tired."
4. (My teacher (who studied in France) speaks fluent French.)
5. The dash pair correctly marks off the extra comment "though long".
6. "Is dinner ready?" asked Mia.
7. A) He packed: trainers, shorts and a towel.; C) He needed three things: focus, time and energy.; E) The winners were: Jo, Alex and Sam.
8. C) semicolon
9. "Wait for me!" called Noah.
10. A colon introduces the list that follows it.
11. C) The power failed; the lightning was fierce.
12. The library (which opens at ten) is free to join.
13. Any correct example, e.g. Dad said, "Breakfast is ready."
14. A) The race was close — until the last lap.; E) The match ended in a tie — a fair result.
15. It needs a capital letter at the start of the speech and punctuation inside the speech marks: She said, "Finally."

Green — Building Fluency

16. The test was tricky; most students still did well.
17. There was only one reason he was smiling: he had passed.
18. A) "I believe," said Omar, "we can win."
19. The weather report — and it is usually accurate — predicted sunshine.
20. A comma can join a main clause to a less formal addition, but a semicolon joins two complete, closely related main clauses. Accept any correct equivalent example.
21. A) The tower (built in 1890) still stands.; C) The recipe (serves six) takes two hours.; E) Our coach (Mrs Lane) is very encouraging.
22. "I cannot believe it," he gasped. "We actually won!"
23. B) colon
24. A dash feels more informal/dramatic; a colon is more formal and often introduces a list or explanation. Accept any correct equivalent examples.
25. The choir practised daily; they deserved to win.
26. A) He asked, "Are we lost?"
27. There was a simple reason for the delay: the train broke down.
28. A) He likes football; she prefers tennis.; C) It was late; we still finished the walk.; E) The shop opened late; customers waited outside.
29. Any correct sentence using a colon before a dramatic statement.
30. Any correct sentence punctuated three ways with a dash, brackets and commas.

Standard / Advanced

31. "Are you ready?" asked Lily. "I just need one more minute," replied Theo.
32. A semicolon joins two complete, equally weighted main clauses; a colon introduces something that explains or lists what came before. Accept any correct original examples.
33. C) My favourite subjects are these: maths, art and science.

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34. The challenge needs just one thing: courage, and plenty of it.
35. A) The road was icy; drivers slowed down.; C) Some pupils chose chess; others chose debate.; E) It snowed heavily; the lesson still went ahead.
36. Any correct example, e.g. "Stop," she said. "I forgot something."
37. C) The outcome — surprisingly — was unexpected.
38. A colon introduces an explanation or example of what was just said ('something unexpected' is then named as 'old photographs'); a semicolon only joins two equally weighted clauses, which this is not.
39. "I have solved the puzzle," she announced. "It was hidden in plain sight the whole time."
40. A) She had one aim: to finish; nothing else mattered.
41. A dash feels more dramatic/informal for the same idea; brackets feel more formal/neutral. Accept any correct equivalent pair of example sentences.
42. The whistle blew; every player stopped instantly. (or: The whistle blew. Every player stopped instantly.)
43. A) "Why is it so quiet?" asked Finn.; E) "Why is it so quiet?" Finn asked.
44. Any correct sentence combining brackets and a colon.
45. It needs an exclamation mark (or full stop) and a closing speech mark before the reporting clause: She shouted, "Stop!" and then ran off.

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